SAMUEL APOYA

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EDUCATION

Colby College **Waterville, ME**
Majors: Computer Science & Economics ***Bachelor of Arts expected, May 2026***
Coursework: Data Structures and Algorithms, Neural Networks, Analysis of Algorithms, Mathematical Data Analysis and Visualization, Object-Oriented Programming, Calculus, Linear Algebra, Computer Architecture, Statistics and Probability
Technical Skills:

- **Proficient: Python, Java, C/ C++, JavaScript, Scala, SQL, TypeScript, React, HTML/CSS, SQL, AWS, TensorFlow**
- Good**: Ruby, NodeJS, Vue, Google Cloud**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Colby College IT Support Center **October 2022 – Present**
IT and Software Services Intern

- Perform unit and integration testing for the ITS center's lead developer, improving software reliability by 20%
- Manage software configurations, updates, and daily backups for 20+ students and faculty, ensuring 100% system uptime and data integrity
- Oversee daily software updates on lecture room computers, ensuring 100% software availability and optimal performance for all classes

Colby Computer Science Department **February 2022 - present**
Teaching Assistant, Researcher (Python, Java, C++)

- Guide 50+ students each week in completing AI and software development projects during office hours
- Improved student evaluations from consistent C's to consistent A's
- Received "Most Valuable TA" Award from Computer Science Department

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Project Feedback (JavaScript, CSS, HTML, MongoDB, Firebase) - Developer **November 2023**

- Developed an anonymous feedback system that addressed communication gaps within Colby's ITS department, improving overall work conditions by over 30%
- System enabled supervisors to promptly resolve issues through enhanced communication
- Extended the system to 4 additional departments, benefiting over 200 employees by streamlining internal communication

Project Handwritten Digits Classifier (Python, Numpy, SciPy, Pandas) **May 2024**

- Developed a **Radial Basis Neural Network** to classify handwritten digits, achieving over 90% accuracy on both training and test datasets
- Optimized feature processing using normalization and dimensionality reduction for improved accuracy and faster training times, reducing noise in input features
- Validated network performance with a confusion matrix, identifying classification errors and improving network reliability
- Benchmarked against K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) for comparison, achieving competitive accuracy with faster processing on the MNIST and other datasets that contained handwritten digits from friends.

Project ServeTogether (React, Node.js with Express, CSS, Firebase) - Developer **May 2024**

- Developed a volunteer platform that aggregates web-based volunteer opportunities, enabling users to explore meaningful service options
- Designed a user friendly interface, encouraging users to explore volunteer opportunities
- system helped 10 friends find volunteer work at the college while learning helpful skills

Project AI Health Wizard (TensorFlow, AWS, Python, React, MySQL) - In progress **October 2024**

- Developed a full-stack wellness platform intended to track daily productivity and health by suggesting healthy daily habits based on one's daily activities.
- Used TensorFlow to train the system to generate clever prompts and tips to help user break out of their busy routines to focus on their health
- System almost ready to be deployed on AWS to ensure scalable infrastructure to promote continuous access to wellness insights and recommendations

ACTIVITIES & LEADERSHIP

Colby Hackers **September 2022 - present**
Club Member

- Competitor in annual Colby-Bowdoin-Bates Hackathon, placing 2nd out of 20 teams
- Organizes local coding fests for about 15 colleagues on semester basis

CodePath, Color Stack and Blacks in Technology (BIT) **September 2022 - present**

- Consistently attend workshops to refine my career path in technology.
- Mentored by senior software engineers to learn and apply best practices in software development